

# UPSC PRELIMS PRACTICE — PAPER 1 (General Studies + CSAT)

Date: 2026-06-21 | Maximum Marks: 200 | Time: 2 Hours

Topics: Static (Ancient History, Geography) + Current Affairs (June 2026) + CSAT Aptitude

## INSTRUCTIONS:

- This paper contains 100 multiple-choice questions. Each question carries 2 marks (Total 200).
- There is NEGATIVE marking: minus 0.66 mark for every wrong answer. No deduction for unattempted questions.
- Q.1-32 = GS Static | Q.33-80 = GS Current Affairs | Q.81-100 = CSAT (Aptitude, Hard).
- Each item has exactly ONE most appropriate answer among (a), (b), (c), (d).
- Use of calculators or electronic devices is NOT permitted.
- This question paper carries NO answer key. Mark answers on a separate grid and submit for evaluation.

## PART I — GENERAL STUDIES (STATIC) (Q.1-32)

History (Ancient India) and Geography. One correct answer each.

### ■ A. Ancient India (History)

**Q1.** Among the Harappan sites, which one is best known for its artificial dockyard, indicating maritime trade?

- |                |            |
|----------------|------------|
| (a) Kalibangan | (b) Lothal |
| (c) Banawali   | (d) Ropar  |

**Q2.** The structure known as the 'Great Bath' has been found at which Harappan site?

- |                 |                |
|-----------------|----------------|
| (a) Harappa     | (b) Dholavira  |
| (c) Mohenjodaro | (d) Chanhudaro |

**Q3.** Consider the following statements about the Harappan script:

1. It was generally written in the boustrophedon style.
2. It has been conclusively deciphered by modern scholars.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- |                  |                     |
|------------------|---------------------|
| (a) 1 only       | (b) 2 only          |
| (c) Both 1 and 2 | (d) Neither 1 nor 2 |

**Q4.** Painted Grey Ware (PGW), an important archaeological marker, is most closely associated with which period?

- |                          |                            |
|--------------------------|----------------------------|
| (a) Harappan urban phase | (b) The Later Vedic period |
| (c) The Mauryan period   | (d) The Gupta period       |

**Q5.** With reference to Rig Vedic polity and society, consider the following statements:

1. The Vidatha was among the earliest folk assemblies.
2. Women could attend assemblies such as the Sabha and the Vidatha.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- |                  |                     |
|------------------|---------------------|
| (a) 1 only       | (b) 2 only          |
| (c) Both 1 and 2 | (d) Neither 1 nor 2 |

**Q6.** In Later Vedic texts, the term 'Krishna Ayas' most likely refers to which metal?

- |            |            |
|------------|------------|
| (a) Gold   | (b) Copper |
| (c) Silver | (d) Iron   |

**Q7.** Which of the following Mahajanapada-capital pairs is correctly matched?

- |                    |                          |
|--------------------|--------------------------|
| (a) Anga - Champa  | (b) Avanti - Vaishali    |
| (c) Vatsa - Rajgir | (d) Kosala - Pataliputra |

**Q8.** Consider the following factors often cited for the rise of Magadha:

1. Proximity to rich iron-ore deposits.
2. Use of elephants in warfare.
3. Fertile plains and control of Gangetic trade routes.

Which of the above contributed to Magadha's success?

- |                  |                  |
|------------------|------------------|
| (a) 1 and 2 only | (b) 2 and 3 only |
| (c) 1 and 3 only | (d) 1, 2 and 3   |

**Q9.** The 'Three Jewels' (Triratna) of Jainism include all of the following EXCEPT:

- |                      |                   |
|----------------------|-------------------|
| (a) Right Meditation | (b) Right Faith   |
| (c) Right Knowledge  | (d) Right Conduct |

**Q10.** The doctrine of 'Pratityasamutpada' (Dependent Origination) is most central to which tradition?

- |                  |                     |
|------------------|---------------------|
| (a) Jainism      | (b) Buddhism        |
| (c) Ajivika sect | (d) Charvaka school |

**Q11.** The First Buddhist Council, held soon after the Buddha's death, met at:

- |               |                 |
|---------------|-----------------|
| (a) Vaishali  | (b) Pataliputra |
| (c) Rajagriha | (d) Kundalvana  |

**Q12.** Megasthenes, the author of 'Indica', was an ambassador to the court of:

- |               |                         |
|---------------|-------------------------|
| (a) Bindusara | (b) Bimbisara           |
| (c) Ashoka    | (d) Chandragupta Maurya |

**Q13.** In most of the Indian subcontinent, the Ashokan edicts were inscribed primarily in which script?

- |               |             |
|---------------|-------------|
| (a) Kharosthi | (b) Brahmi  |
| (c) Greek     | (d) Aramaic |

**Q14.** With reference to Ashoka's Dhamma, consider the following statements:

1. Officers called Dhamma Mahamattas were appointed to propagate it.
2. It immediately and completely abolished all animal sacrifice across the empire.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- |                  |                     |
|------------------|---------------------|
| (a) 1 only       | (b) 2 only          |
| (c) Both 1 and 2 | (d) Neither 1 nor 2 |

**Q15.** The Sohagaura and Mahasthan inscriptions, which mention relief measures, are generally assigned to which period?

- |            |                |
|------------|----------------|
| (a) Gupta  | (b) Mauryan    |
| (c) Kushan | (d) Satavahana |

**Q16.** Which one of the following gives the correct chronological sequence (earliest first)?

- |                                                      |                                                      |
|------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| (a) Neolithic - Mesolithic - Chalcolithic - Harappan | (b) Mesolithic - Chalcolithic - Neolithic - Harappan |
| (c) Mesolithic - Neolithic - Chalcolithic - Harappan | (d) Neolithic - Chalcolithic - Mesolithic - Harappan |

## ■ B. Geography (Physical & General)

**Q17.** Which one of the following gives the correct order of atmospheric layers upward from the Earth's surface?

- |                                                            |                                                            |
|------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| (a) Troposphere - Stratosphere - Mesosphere - Thermosphere | (b) Stratosphere - Troposphere - Thermosphere - Mesosphere |
| (c) Troposphere - Mesosphere - Stratosphere - Thermosphere | (d) Mesosphere - Troposphere - Stratosphere - Thermosphere |

**Q18.** The ozone layer that absorbs most ultraviolet radiation is located mainly in the:

- |                 |                  |
|-----------------|------------------|
| (a) Troposphere | (b) Stratosphere |
| (c) Mesosphere  | (d) Thermosphere |

**Q19.** The 'Horse Latitudes' correspond to which global pressure belt?

- |                      |                  |
|----------------------|------------------|
| (a) Equatorial low   | (b) Subpolar low |
| (c) Subtropical high | (d) Polar high   |

**Q20.** In the Northern Hemisphere, the trade winds generally blow from the:

- |                                       |                                       |
|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| (a) North-east towards the south-west | (b) North-west towards the south-east |
| (c) South-east towards the north-west | (d) South-west towards the north-east |

**Q21.** The single-cell meridional (equator-to-pole) circulation model of the atmosphere was first proposed by:

- |                      |                   |
|----------------------|-------------------|
| (a) William Ferrel   | (b) George Hadley |
| (c) Gaspard Coriolis | (d) Carl Rossby   |

**Q22.** The mid-latitude westerlies are most closely associated with the passage of:

- |                                      |                       |
|--------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| (a) Tropical cyclones                | (b) Tornadoes         |
| (c) Temperate cyclones (depressions) | (d) Anticyclones only |

**Q23.** Owing to the Coriolis effect, freely moving winds are deflected to their right in the:

- |                          |                              |
|--------------------------|------------------------------|
| (a) Southern Hemisphere  | (b) Northern Hemisphere      |
| (c) Equatorial belt only | (d) Both hemispheres equally |

**Q24.** The Koeppen scheme of climate classification is based primarily on:

- |                                               |                          |
|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| (a) Temperature alone                         | (b) Rainfall alone       |
| (c) Temperature, precipitation and vegetation | (d) Atmospheric pressure |

**Q25.** Among the following water bodies, which records the highest surface salinity?

- |                   |                  |
|-------------------|------------------|
| (a) Baltic Sea    | (b) Dead Sea     |
| (c) Bay of Bengal | (d) Arctic Ocean |

**Q26.** The Gulf Stream of the North Atlantic is an example of a:

- |                        |                        |
|------------------------|------------------------|
| (a) Warm ocean current | (b) Cold ocean current |
| (c) Tidal bore         | (d) Coastal upwelling  |

**Q27.** Consider the following conditions for the growth of coral reefs:

1. Warm waters, roughly 20-25 degrees C.
2. Shallow, clear and sediment-free water.
3. A steady inflow of fresh river water.

Which of the above conditions are favourable?

- |                  |                  |
|------------------|------------------|
| (a) 1 and 3 only | (b) 2 and 3 only |
| (c) 1 and 2 only | (d) 1, 2 and 3   |

**Q28.** Basalt, formed from solidified lava, is an example of which rock type?

- |                      |                  |
|----------------------|------------------|
| (a) Sedimentary rock | (b) Igneous rock |
| (c) Metamorphic rock | (d) Organic rock |

**Q29.** The point on the Earth's surface directly above the focus of an earthquake is called the:

- |                |                  |
|----------------|------------------|
| (a) Hypocentre | (b) Fault scarp  |
| (c) Epicentre  | (d) Seismic node |

**Q30.** Which type of seismic wave CANNOT travel through liquids, thereby helping locate the Earth's outer core?

- |                       |                         |
|-----------------------|-------------------------|
| (a) Primary (P) waves | (b) Secondary (S) waves |
| (c) Surface waves     | (d) Sound waves         |

**Q31.** Which one of the following is NOT a terrestrial (inner) planet?

- |             |             |
|-------------|-------------|
| (a) Mercury | (b) Venus   |
| (c) Mars    | (d) Jupiter |

**Q32.** Spring tides, the highest tides, occur when the Sun, the Moon and the Earth are:

- |                                         |                                                   |
|-----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| (a) At right angles to one another      | (b) Aligned in a straight line (new or full moon) |
| (c) With the Moon at its farthest point | (d) During the first quarter only                 |

## PART II — GENERAL STUDIES (CURRENT AFFAIRS, June 2026) (Q.33-80)

Concept, institution, geography and data based. One correct answer each.

### ■ A. Polity & Governance

**Q33.** The 91st Constitutional Amendment Act, 2003, made which key change to the anti-defection framework (Tenth Schedule)?

- |                                                  |                                                                       |
|--------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| (a) Introduced the 'split' exemption             | (b) Deleted the provision that exempted a 'split' (one-third members) |
| (c) Raised the merger threshold to three-fourths | (d) Abolished the Tenth Schedule                                      |

**Q34.** Under the Tenth Schedule, a defection is protected from disqualification on the ground of a 'merger' only if at least how much of the legislature party agrees?

- |                |                   |
|----------------|-------------------|
| (a) One-third  | (b) One-half      |
| (c) Two-thirds | (d) Three-fourths |

**Q35.** Questions of disqualification under the anti-defection law are decided by:

- |                             |                                              |
|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| (a) The President/Governor  | (b) The Presiding Officer (Speaker/Chairman) |
| (c) The Election Commission | (d) The Supreme Court in the first instance  |

**Q36.** With reference to the Waqf (Amendment) Act, 2025, consider the following:

1. It provides for inclusion of non-Muslim members in Waqf Boards.
2. Articles 25 and 26 of the Constitution deal with freedom of religion.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- |                  |                     |
|------------------|---------------------|
| (a) 1 only       | (b) 2 only          |
| (c) Both 1 and 2 | (d) Neither 1 nor 2 |

**Q37.** A Uniform Civil Code for citizens is envisaged under which part of the Constitution?

- |                        |                                                       |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| (a) Fundamental Rights | (b) Directive Principles of State Policy (Article 44) |
| (c) Fundamental Duties | (d) The Preamble                                      |

**Q38.** Regarding the Women's Reservation Act, 2023 (Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam), consider the following:

1. It provides 33% reservation for women in the Lok Sabha and State Legislative Assemblies.
2. Its implementation is linked to delimitation following a census.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- |                  |                     |
|------------------|---------------------|
| (a) 1 only       | (b) 2 only          |
| (c) Both 1 and 2 | (d) Neither 1 nor 2 |

**Q39.** Members of the Rajya Sabha (and the recent Mizoram seat) are elected by:

- |                                   |                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| (a) Direct election by the people | (b) Elected MLAs through proportional representation by single transferable vote |
| (c) Lok Sabha members             | (d) Nomination by the President only                                             |

**Q40.** With reference to the Census in India, consider the following statements:

1. The Census is conducted under the Census Act, 1948.
2. 'Census' is a subject in the Union List.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- |                  |                     |
|------------------|---------------------|
| (a) 1 only       | (b) 2 only          |
| (c) Both 1 and 2 | (d) Neither 1 nor 2 |

**Q41.** The Supreme Court's recognition of a 'right to walk / access to footpaths' was read into which fundamental right?

- |                |                |
|----------------|----------------|
| (a) Article 14 | (b) Article 19 |
| (c) Article 21 | (d) Article 32 |

**Q42.** With reference to internet/platform blocking in India, consider the following:

1. Section 69A of the IT Act empowers the government to block information in the interest of public order and security.
2. Section 66A of the IT Act was struck down in *Shreya Singhal v. Union of India*.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- |                     |                  |
|---------------------|------------------|
| (a) 1 only          | (b) 2 only       |
| (c) Neither 1 nor 2 | (d) Both 1 and 2 |

**Q43.** A government committee constituted only to examine and advise on demographic change is best described as:

- |                                        |                      |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------|
| (a) A constitutional body              | (b) A statutory body |
| (c) A non-statutory advisory committee | (d) A tribunal       |

**Q44.** Parliament's power to provide for adjudication of inter-State river water disputes (such as the Cauvery) is derived from:

- |                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| (a) Article 262 | (b) Article 263 |
| (c) Article 252 | (d) Article 356 |

**Q45.** The Cauvery Water Management Authority was constituted pursuant to directions of the:

- |                         |                       |
|-------------------------|-----------------------|
| (a) Inter-State Council | (b) Supreme Court     |
| (c) NITI Aayog          | (d) Lok Sabha Speaker |

**Q46.** A 'special majority' (e.g., two-thirds of members present and voting) is required for:

- |                                                  |                            |
|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| (a) Passing an ordinary bill                     | (b) A no-confidence motion |
| (c) A Constitutional Amendment under Article 368 | (d) Electing the Speaker   |

## ■ B. International Relations

**Q47.** The Strait of Hormuz, a strategic choke point, connects the:

- |                                       |                                       |
|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| (a) Red Sea and the Mediterranean     | (b) Persian Gulf and the Gulf of Oman |
| (c) Arabian Sea and the Bay of Bengal | (d) Black Sea and the Caspian Sea     |

**Q48.** With reference to the Strait of Hormuz, consider the following:

1. Iran lies along its northern shore.
2. It is one of the world's most important transit routes for crude oil and LNG.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- |                  |                     |
|------------------|---------------------|
| (a) 1 only       | (b) 2 only          |
| (c) Both 1 and 2 | (d) Neither 1 nor 2 |

**Q49.** The International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA), often in the news over uranium enrichment, is headquartered at:

- |              |               |
|--------------|---------------|
| (a) Geneva   | (b) Vienna    |
| (c) New York | (d) The Hague |

**Q50.** Under the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT), a state is recognised as a nuclear-weapon state if it manufactured and tested a device before:

- |                    |                    |
|--------------------|--------------------|
| (a) 1 January 1967 | (b) 1 January 1970 |
| (c) 18 May 1974    | (d) 11 May 1998    |

**Q51.** The strategy of 'Military-Civil Fusion', frequently cited in defence-trade restrictions, is associated with which country?

- |            |                 |
|------------|-----------------|
| (a) Russia | (b) China       |
| (c) Iran   | (d) North Korea |

**Q52.** A merchant ship registered in a country other than that of its owners, mainly for cost or regulatory advantage, is said to sail under a:

- |                         |                    |
|-------------------------|--------------------|
| (a) Letter of Marque    | (b) Bill of Lading |
| (c) Flag of Convenience | (d) Free Pratique  |

**Q53.** Operation Sankalp refers to the Indian Navy's deployment for the safety of shipping in the:

- |                       |                                        |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------|
| (a) South China Sea   | (b) Gulf of Oman / Persian Gulf region |
| (c) Mediterranean Sea | (d) Bay of Bengal                      |

**Q54.** The long-term strategic 'Horizon 2047' roadmap is part of India's partnership with which country?

- |             |                   |
|-------------|-------------------|
| (a) Germany | (b) United States |
| (c) France  | (d) Japan         |

**Q55.** A Free Trade Agreement (FTA) primarily aims to:

- |                                     |                                                                 |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| (a) Impose a common external tariff | (b) Reduce or eliminate tariffs on goods traded between members |
| (c) Establish a single currency     | (d) Allow only free movement of labour                          |



## ■ C. Economy

**Q56.** The Wholesale Price Index (WPI), whose base year was recently revised, is compiled and released by the:

- |                                           |                                 |
|-------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| (a) Reserve Bank of India                 | (b) National Statistical Office |
| (c) Office of the Economic Adviser, DPIIT | (d) Labour Bureau               |

**Q57.** A Producer Price Index (PPI) measures the average change in prices from the standpoint of the:

- |                    |                     |
|--------------------|---------------------|
| (a) Final consumer | (b) Producer/seller |
| (c) Importer       | (d) Retailer        |

**Q58.** Retail (headline) inflation in India is officially measured using the:

- |                                |                  |
|--------------------------------|------------------|
| (a) WPI                        | (b) GDP deflator |
| (c) Consumer Price Index (CPI) | (d) PPI          |

**Q59.** Under its flexible inflation-targeting framework, the RBI's CPI inflation target is:

- |                                     |                                     |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| (a) 2% with a band of plus/minus 2% | (b) 4% with a band of plus/minus 2% |
| (c) 6% with a band of plus/minus 2% | (d) 5% with a band of plus/minus 1% |

**Q60.** Under the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, the adjudicating authority for corporate insolvency is the:

- |                                          |                            |
|------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| (a) National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) | (b) Debt Recovery Tribunal |
| (c) SARFAESI Authority                   | (d) High Court             |

**Q61.** A Corporate Insolvency Resolution Process (CIRP) under the IBC may be initiated by which of the following?

1. A financial creditor.
2. An operational creditor.
3. The corporate debtor itself.

Select the correct answer:

- |                  |                  |
|------------------|------------------|
| (a) 1 only       | (b) 1 and 2 only |
| (c) 2 and 3 only | (d) 1, 2 and 3   |

**Q62.** Basic Customs Duty on imported goods is levied under the:

- |                        |                       |
|------------------------|-----------------------|
| (a) GST Act            | (b) Customs Act, 1962 |
| (c) Central Excise Act | (d) FEMA              |

## ■ D. Environment & Ecology

**Q63.** Diverting water from one river basin to another (e.g., Ganga canal water to the Yamuna) is conceptually an example of:

- |                                               |                                  |
|-----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| (a) Inter-basin transfer / river interlinking | (b) Desalination                 |
| (c) Cloud seeding                             | (d) Rooftop rainwater harvesting |

**Q64.** BESS, increasingly vital for integrating variable renewable energy into the grid, stands for:

- |                                       |                                   |
|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| (a) Bulk Energy Supply System         | (b) Battery Energy Storage System |
| (c) Base-load Electric Supply Station | (d) Biomass Energy Source System  |

**Q65.** India's target for installed non-fossil-fuel (renewable) electricity capacity by the year 2030 is about:

- |            |             |
|------------|-------------|
| (a) 175 GW | (b) 350 GW  |
| (c) 500 GW | (d) 1000 GW |

**Q66.** At COP26 (Glasgow), India announced a net-zero emissions target for the year:

- |          |          |
|----------|----------|
| (a) 2050 | (b) 2070 |
| (c) 2060 | (d) 2047 |

**Q67.** The 'Long Period Average' (LPA) used by the IMD to describe monsoon rainfall is computed over:

- |                                         |                       |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| (a) The last 10 years                   | (b) The last 5 years  |
| (c) A long reference period (1971-2020) | (d) Exactly 100 years |

**Q68.** El Nino, which can suppress the Indian summer monsoon, is associated with:

- |                                             |                                                                |
|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| (a) Abnormal cooling of the eastern Pacific | (b) Abnormal warming of the central-eastern equatorial Pacific |
| (c) The Indian Ocean Dipole alone           | (d) Warming of the Atlantic Ocean                              |

**Q69.** The Mokedatu balancing-reservoir project, a source of inter-State dispute, is proposed on which river?

- |             |              |
|-------------|--------------|
| (a) Krishna | (b) Godavari |
| (c) Cauvery | (d) Pennar   |

**Q70.** GRAP, invoked to tackle severe air pollution in Delhi-NCR, stands for Graded Response \_\_\_\_ Plan.

- |                 |                |
|-----------------|----------------|
| (a) Action      | (b) Assessment |
| (c) Air-quality | (d) Abatement  |

**Q71.** Coral bleaching, a major ecological concern, is caused primarily by:

- |                      |                                    |
|----------------------|------------------------------------|
| (a) Over-fishing     | (b) Rising sea-surface temperature |
| (c) Oil spills alone | (d) Plastic pollution alone        |

■ **E. Science, Technology, Health & Defence**

**Q72.** The natural reservoir host of the Nipah virus is the:

- |                        |                    |
|------------------------|--------------------|
| (a) Anopheles mosquito | (b) Aedes mosquito |
| (c) Pteropus fruit bat | (d) Common rodent  |

**Q73.** The Nipah virus belongs to which virus family?

- |                   |                     |
|-------------------|---------------------|
| (a) Flaviviridae  | (b) Paramyxoviridae |
| (c) Coronaviridae | (d) Filoviridae     |

**Q74.** Dengue, caused by a virus of the family Flaviviridae, is transmitted to humans mainly by the:

- |                            |                        |
|----------------------------|------------------------|
| (a) Aedes aegypti mosquito | (b) Anopheles mosquito |
| (c) Culex mosquito         | (d) Sandfly            |

**Q75.** 'Antibody-Dependent Enhancement' (ADE), a safety concern in vaccine development, is most discussed in relation to:

- |                  |             |
|------------------|-------------|
| (a) Tuberculosis | (b) Dengue  |
| (c) Polio        | (d) Measles |

**Q76.** GraphCast, an artificial-intelligence weather-forecasting model, was developed by:

- |                     |            |
|---------------------|------------|
| (a) OpenAI          | (b) Huawei |
| (c) Google DeepMind | (d) ISRO   |

**Q77.** Traditional (non-AI) numerical weather prediction relies primarily on:

- |                                       |                                                       |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| (a) Machine-learning pattern matching | (b) Solving physics-based equations on supercomputers |
| (c) Historical analogues alone        | (d) Satellite imagery alone                           |

**Q78.** The Abhigyan application launched for law-enforcement is used for:

- |                                                                    |                       |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| (a) Crop insurance claims                                          | (b) Weather alerts    |
| (c) Instant fingerprint/biometric verification of criminal records | (d) Income-tax filing |

**Q79.** The Agnipath scheme is associated with:

- |                             |                                                  |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| (a) Rural road construction | (b) Short-tenure recruitment to the armed forces |
| (c) Rural electrification   | (d) Skill-development loans                      |

**Q80.** In defence procurement, 'attritable' drone systems are best described as those that are:

- |                                              |                     |
|----------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| (a) Reusable and expensive                   | (b) Nuclear-capable |
| (c) Low-cost and expendable in large numbers | (d) Always manned   |

### PART III — CSAT (APTITUDE) [HARD] (Q.81-100)

Comprehension, reasoning, quantitative aptitude and data interpretation. Answer only from the information given.

#### ■ A. Reading Comprehension

**Q81.** Read Passage-I and answer Q.81-83.

**Passage-I:** The transition from welfare based on official discretion to welfare based on entitlement marks a profound shift in the relationship between citizen and state. When a benefit becomes a right, the burden of justification reverses: the state must now explain why it withholds, not why it grants. Yet rights without the administrative capacity to fulfil them risk becoming hollow promises, breeding cynicism rather than empowerment. The real challenge is therefore not merely to legislate entitlements but to build the institutional plumbing - data systems, grievance redress, last-mile delivery - that makes them real. A right that cannot be enforced is, in practice, hard to distinguish from a favour.

**Q.81** Which one of the following best captures the central idea of the passage?

- |                                                                       |                                                                              |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| (a) Discretionary welfare is always superior to rights-based welfare. | (b) Entitlements must be backed by administrative capacity to be meaningful. |
| (c) Legislation alone is sufficient to empower citizens.              | (d) The state should grant fewer rights to avoid cynicism.                   |

**Q82.** (Passage-I) Which of the following is the most valid inference from the passage?

- |                                                 |                                                                                |
|-------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| (a) Citizens prefer favours to rights.          | (b) Administrative capacity is irrelevant to welfare outcomes.                 |
| (c) Courts should decide all welfare questions. | (d) Legal recognition of a right does not, by itself, guarantee its enjoyment. |

**Q83.** (Passage-I) According to the author, an unenforceable right, in practice, comes to resemble:

- |                            |                         |
|----------------------------|-------------------------|
| (a) A constitutional duty  | (b) A statutory penalty |
| (c) A discretionary favour | (d) A criminal offence  |

**Q84.** Read Passage-II and answer Q.84-85.

**Passage-II:** To speak of 'natural resources' is already to have decided something: that the forest, the river and the mountain exist for us, as inputs to human ends. This grammar is so deeply embedded in policy that we scarcely notice it. An alternative vocabulary - of ecosystems possessing intrinsic worth - struggles to gain purchase precisely because our institutions are built to measure value in units of human use. The deeper obstacle to ecological reform may thus be conceptual before it is technical or financial.

**Q.84** Which one of the following best reflects the main idea of the passage?

- |                                                        |                                                                                 |
|--------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| (a) Natural resources should be exploited efficiently. | (b) The language used to describe nature shapes, and limits, ecological policy. |
| (c) Ecological reform is purely a financial problem.   | (d) Institutions already value ecosystems intrinsically.                        |

**Q85.** (Passage-II) The author would most likely agree that:

- |                                                                      |                                                            |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| (a) Conceptual frameworks can constrain the range of policy choices. | (b) Only technology can solve ecological problems.         |
| (c) Language has no bearing on policy.                               | (d) Human use is the only valid measure of nature's worth. |

■ **B. Logical Reasoning & Analytical Ability**

**Q86.** Pointing to a photograph, Rohan said, "She is the daughter of the only son of my father." How is the woman in the photograph related to Rohan?

- |              |            |
|--------------|------------|
| (a) Mother   | (b) Niece  |
| (c) Daughter | (d) Cousin |

**Q87.** A man starts at a point, walks 5 km North, turns right and walks 3 km, turns right again and walks 5 km, then turns left and walks 2 km. How far and in which direction is he now from the starting point?

- |               |                |
|---------------|----------------|
| (a) 5 km East | (b) 5 km West  |
| (c) 3 km East | (d) 2 km North |

**Q88.** Find the next term in the series: 2, 6, 12, 20, 30, ?

- |        |        |
|--------|--------|
| (a) 40 | (b) 42 |
| (c) 44 | (d) 36 |

**Q89.** Statements: All teachers are readers. Some readers are writers.  
Conclusions: I. Some teachers are writers. II. Some writers are readers.  
Which of the conclusions logically follow(s)?

- |                     |                          |
|---------------------|--------------------------|
| (a) Only I follows  | (b) Both I and II follow |
| (c) Only II follows | (d) Neither follows      |

**Q90.** In a certain code, FROST is written as GSPTU. How will GLOOM be written in that code?

- |           |           |
|-----------|-----------|
| (a) HMPPN | (b) HNPPN |
| (c) HMPQN | (d) GMPPN |

■ **C. Quantitative Aptitude**

**Q91.** The price of a commodity rises by 25%. By what percentage must a household cut its consumption so that its total expenditure on the commodity remains unchanged?

- |         |         |
|---------|---------|
| (a) 25% | (b) 15% |
| (c) 30% | (d) 20% |

**Q92.** A can finish a piece of work in 12 days and B in 18 days. They work together for 4 days, after which A leaves. In how many more days will B alone complete the remaining work?

- (a) 9 (b) 6  
(c) 8 (d) 10

**Q93.** The ratio of the present ages of A and B is 4 : 5. Five years from now, the ratio becomes 5 : 6. What is A's present age (in years)?

- (a) 16 (b) 20  
(c) 24 (d) 25

**Q94.** Find the next term: 3, 7, 16, 35, 74, ?

- (a) 153 (b) 148  
(c) 151 (d) 157

**Q95.** A shopkeeper marks his goods 40% above cost price and then allows a discount of 10% on the marked price. His profit percentage is:

- (a) 30% (b) 25%  
(c) 28% (d) 26%

#### ■ D. Data Interpretation & Data Sufficiency

**Q96.** Study the table of crop production (in lakh tonnes) and answer Q.96-97.

**Q.96** Which State recorded the highest percentage growth in production from 2024 to 2025?

| State | 2024 | 2025 |
|-------|------|------|
| P     | 120  | 150  |
| Q     | 80   | 104  |
| R     | 200  | 180  |
| S     | 150  | 165  |

- (a) State P (b) State Q  
(c) State R (d) State S

**Q97.** (Refer to the table in Q.96) The combined production of all four States in 2025 exceeded that in 2024 by approximately:

- (a) 9% (b) 12%  
(c) 8% (d) 11%

**Q98.** Each question below is followed by two statements. Decide which statement(s) is/are sufficient.

Question: Is  $x$  greater than  $y$ ?

Statement I:  $x + 2 > y + 2$ .

Statement II:  $x^2 > y^2$ .

- |                                                          |                                         |
|----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| (a) Statement II alone is sufficient, but I alone is not | (b) Each statement alone is sufficient  |
| (c) Statement I alone is sufficient, but II alone is not | (d) Both statements together are needed |

**Q99.** Question: What is the two-digit number?

Statement I: The sum of its digits is 9.

Statement II: The difference of its digits is 3.

- |                                             |                                                       |
|---------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| (a) Statement I alone is sufficient         | (b) Statement II alone is sufficient                  |
| (c) Both statements together are sufficient | (d) Both statements together are still not sufficient |

**Q100.** How many triangles are there in a square in which both the diagonals have been drawn?

- |       |        |
|-------|--------|
| (a) 8 | (b) 4  |
| (c) 6 | (d) 10 |

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— END OF QUESTION PAPER —

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